

Development Log

Project Name: ConnectHub – A Student Networking

Developer: Harsh Vishwakarma

Tech Stack: Next.js, Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB, Clerk, Cloudinary

Week 1: Project Planning and Setup

- Finalized project idea: a LinkedIn-like platform tailored for students.
 - Defined feature list: user profiles, posts, research uploads, connections.
 - Created GitHub repository and initialized project.
 - Installed and set up Next.js for frontend.
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Week 2: Authentication and Basic Routing

- Integrated **Clerk** for secure authentication (signup/login).
 - Created login and registration pages using Clerk components.
 - Setup routing structure in Next.js (Home, Profile, Feed pages).
 - Tested authentication flows and redirection.
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Week 3: Backend Setup and MongoDB Integration

- Set up Node.js with Express server as backend API.
 - Connected backend to **MongoDB Atlas**.
 - Created database schemas for User, Post, and Connection.
 - Implemented REST APIs for user registration, profile updates, and post creation.
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Week 4: Cloudinary Integration and File Handling

- Integrated **Cloudinary** for uploading documents and images.
- Created upload API to handle research paper uploads and resume files.

- Added support for displaying media on user profiles and posts.
 - Implemented error handling for upload limits and file types.
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Week 5: UI Development and Feature Integration

- Built **Profile Page, Post Feed, and Explore Section**.
 - Integrated APIs with frontend using Axios.
 - Created components: PostCard, UploadForm, ProfileCard.
 - Implemented follow/connect functionality between users.
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Week 6: Testing, Bug Fixes, and Deployment

- Conducted manual and API testing using Postman.
- Fixed CORS issues and improved backend error handling.
- Performed UI testing for responsiveness on mobile and desktop.
- Finalized and deployed frontend and backend to Vercel/Render.
- Created a demo video walkthrough and organized documentation.